PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Cosmetic Microneedling

The device maker's directions always come first. Times are typical.

CHECK YOUR STATE FIRST · Many states, including California, bar estheticians from microneedling; others cap depth or require a medical director. Get it in writing from your board. Stay at or under [__ mm, per your state & device].

DEVICE
FDA-cleared pen only. Sealed, sterile, single-use cartridge for every client and every visit.

CONSULT
Intake, consent and Fitzpatrick done. No Accutane in 6 months. Retinoids off 5 days.

INTERVAL
4–6 weeks apart, never under 3. Series of 3–6. Prime deeper skin tones with daily SPF.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Pen in a fresh barrier sleeve ☐ Sealed cartridge ☐ Sharps container ☐ Gloves & sterile gauze ☐ Antiseptic & saline ☐ Approved glide

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Review & photo**	3–5 min	Confirm health changes. Stop for active acne, cold sore, infection or sunburn. Before photos.
2	**Cleanse & numb**	2–30 min	Cleanse. Topical numbing only if your state allows it for estheticians; remove it completely.
3	**Antiseptic prep**	2 min	Fresh gloves. Antiseptic over the whole area; let it dry. Hair covered.
4	**Open & set depth**	1 min	Open the cartridge in front of the client. Set depth for each zone: shallower on the forehead and around the eyes.
5	**Treat**	15–20 min	Thin layer of glide the device maker allows. Skin taut, pen upright, light pressure. Small sections, 2–3 crosshatch passes. Ease off over bone.
6	**Watch the endpoint**	—	Even pink to red. Cosmetic depth gives little or no pinpoint bleeding. Don't chase bleeding.
7	**Dispose**	1 min	Cartridge straight into sharps. Never reuse. Discard the sleeve; disinfect the pen per the maker.
8	**Cleanse & calm**	5 min	Saline gauze. Cool compress. Simple, sterile, fragrance-free soothing product only.
9	**Educate & rebook**	3 min	Aftercare handout. Mineral SPF from tomorrow. Book 4–6 weeks out.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Heavy bleeding: stop, press with gauze.
- Hives or swelling: stop. 911 if breathing is affected.
- Pustules, oozing, fever later: refer to a physician.
- Needlestick to you: wash, follow your exposure plan.
- Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24–48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS TREATMENT

Device · cartridge lot	Depth by zone (mm)	Speed · passes	Glide · numbing used
Endpoint · redness 0–3	**Products after**	**Client comfort 0–10**	**Reaction · initials**